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General Comment

Any AI plan should include legal protections for all copyrighted works (including literature, visual art and music) from being used as training data for AI models without their respective copyright holders' consent. AI is not intelligent, despite its name, and is unable to make informed decisions about how to use copyrighted works in a manner consistent with fair use laws. We have already seen many instances where AI spits out an almost 1:1 copy of copyrighted works, and allowing it to train in copyrighted material would simply provide a legal buffer for entities to profit off of existing works with impunity.

This plan should also prohibit the use of AI from being used for making any decisions regarding hiring/firing of employees, whether in state/federal government or the private sector. Again, AI is not intelligent, and cannot be held liable for management decisions. We have recently seen it make very unfortunate mistakes when used for DOGE department cuts, terminating employees or contracts based on keywords the technology is unable to evaluate in context. Human beings should always be chiefly responsible for the handling of other human beings.

Finally, AI should be kept out of education. Generative AI should not be used in the process of teaching children to write or produce music or artwork. Recent studies conducted by Microsoft have confirmed that use of AI impairs critical thinking, which is entirely antithetical to the mission of education. I have read some very disturbing stories about companies proposing the use of AI chatbots as counselors or therapists for students, which would be devastating to their mental health. Unchecked deployment of AI in childcare and education could have a disastrous effect on the next generation of American workers.

I would also like to add that our leaders should interrogate the notion that the US needs to compete with the rest of the world in the field of AI at all. None of the companies pushing the technology have provided any convincing argument to justify its existence. It can't replace human programmers, for instance, as it is too error-prone to be anything but a liability without human workers to check its output, which is far less efficient than simply hiring human coders to do the work themselves. For the same reason, AI can't be used to responsibly generate informative or persuasive writing - there was a prominent news story last year about a family that was poisoned because they bought an AI-generated book on foraging mushrooms. It can't generate commercially viable art, literature or music, because no human consumer is interested in art generated by a prompt they could type into a model themselves - they go to these forms of entertainment specifically for their human element.

Given that AI has failed to generate profit in the private sector, it is difficult to see any grants or contracts that the government might provide as anything other than a bailout for failing businesses. I would think that any administration that claims to be focused on reducing the deficit or restoring us to a meritocracy would want to stay far away from AI. Perhaps the way to stay competitive with Russia or China in the AI space would be to let them waste billions more dollars on it while we surpass them in the industries they're neglecting.